

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U18 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U14 (2 Jan 2012 or after)
- U16 (2 Jan 2010 or after)
- U18 (2 Jan 2008 or after)

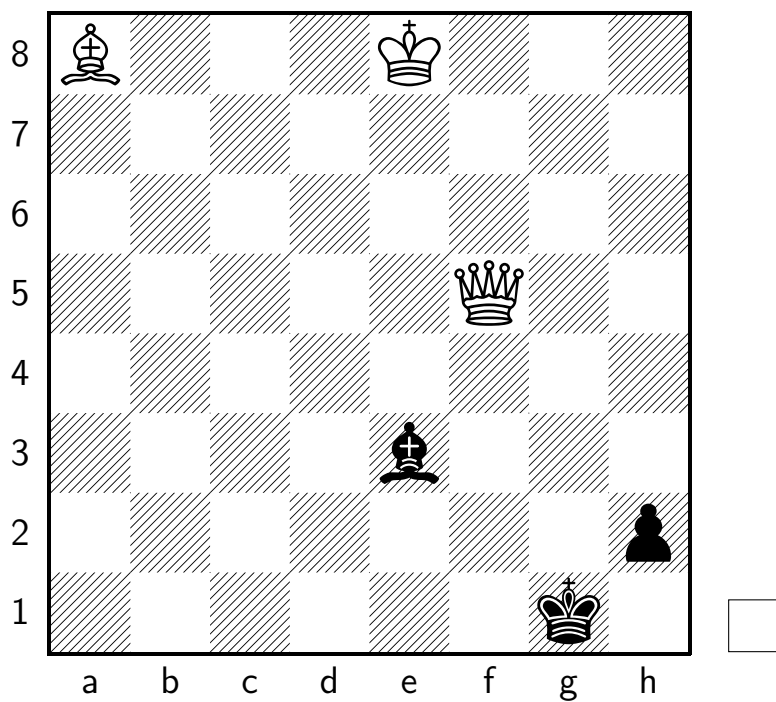
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You may leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions generally go from easy to hard, so it's best to start from the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and the marks you can score. Please write your answers in the space under each diagram. Altogether, the test has 100 marks. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial marks.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Q1. Mate in 3. (4 marks)

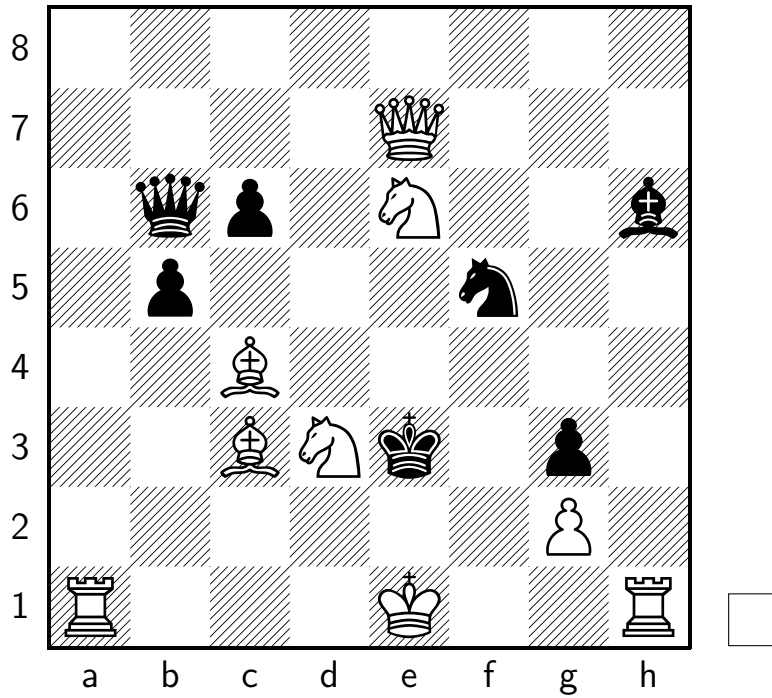


Answer:

- 1 ♖h1 ♔xh1
- 2 ♕f1+ ♘g1
- 3 ♕f3#

Source: S.P Tsirulik 1956

Q2. Mate in 2. (4 marks)



Answer:

1 O-O-O (1 O-O fails to 1...bxc4)

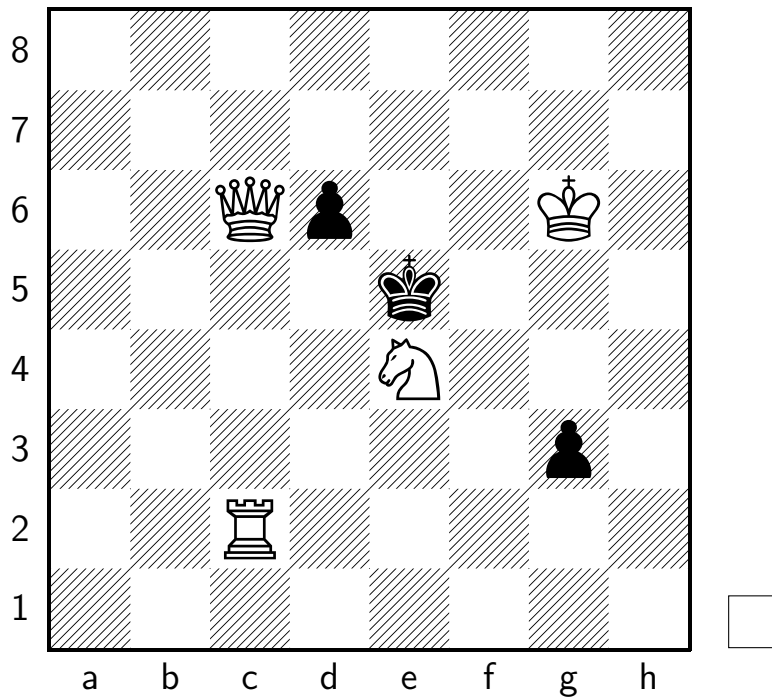
1... ♔e2+ 2 ♘ef4#

1... ♔e4+ 2 ♘g5#

1... ♘d4 2 ♘xd4#

Source: Michael Lipton, Great Britain - Israel, 1961 (YACPDB: 36663)

Q3. Mate in 2. (4 marks)



Answer:

1 ♘g5 (All seven remaining knight jumps can be met with a refutation.)

1... ♔d4 2 ♕e4#

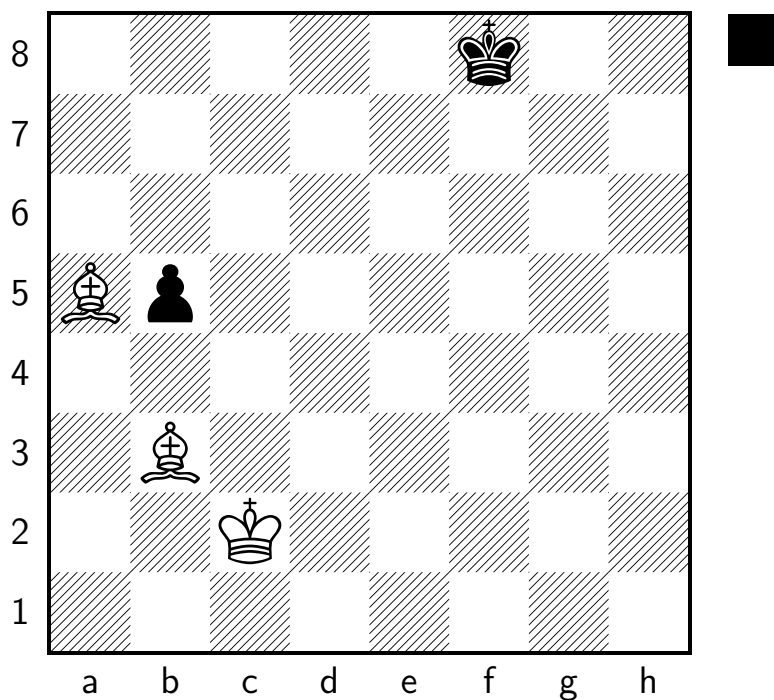
1... ♔f4 2 ♕e4#

1... g2 2 ♕e4#

1... d5 2 ♕f6#

Source: Gerhard Paul Latzel, Die Schwalbe, 1956 (YACPD: 41896)

Q4. Helpmate in 5. Black to play first and help White to mate in 5 moves. (6 marks)



Answer:

0... ♔e7

1 ♘e1 ♔d6

2 ♔d2 ♔c5

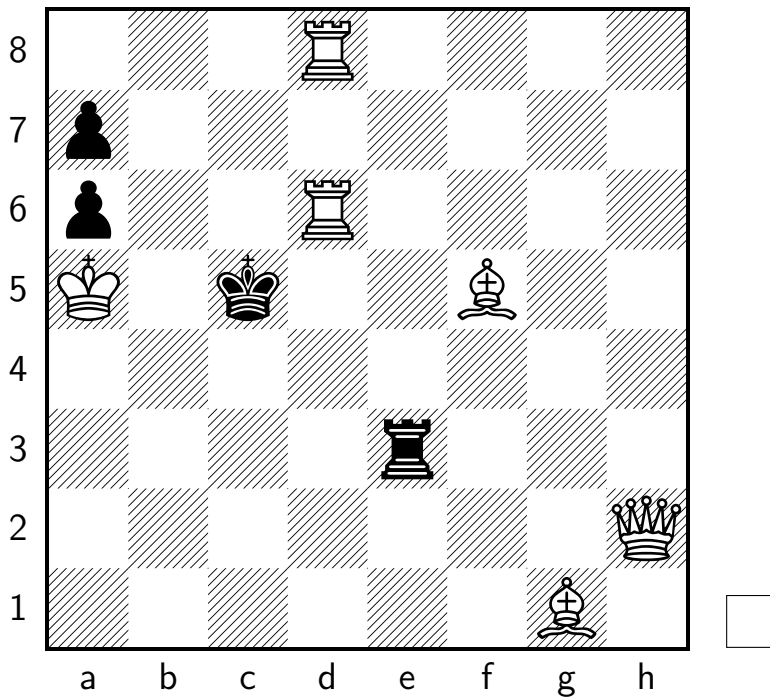
3 ♘d1 ♔b4

4 ♔c2+ ♔a4

5 ♔b2#

Source: Ebert & Maslar, diagrammes, 1980 (YACPDB: 305488)

Q5. Selfmate in 5. White to play and force Black to checkmate White in 5 moves. (6 marks)



Answer:

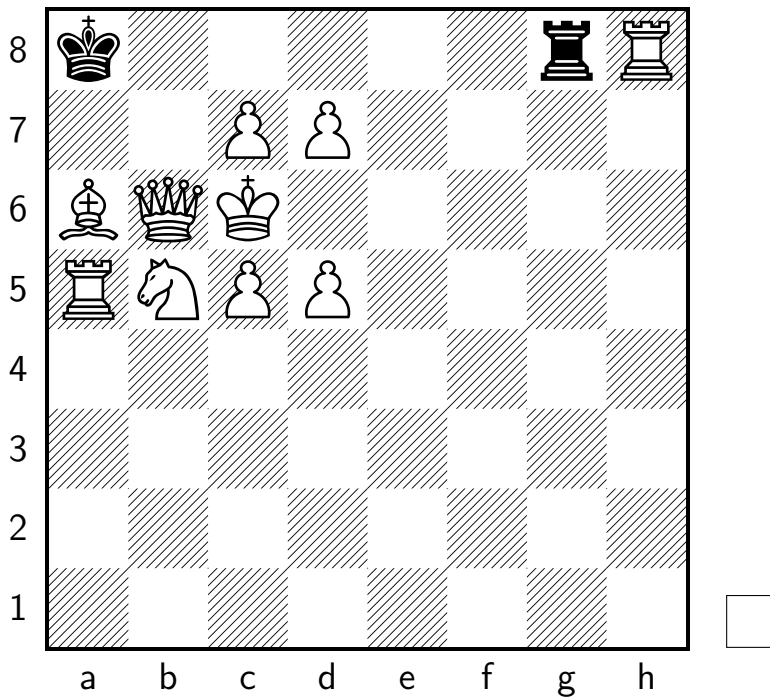
1 ♖d1 ♔c4
 2 ♚c2+ ♜c3
 3 ♚a2+ ♜b3
 4 ♙d3+ ♔c3
 5 ♚a3 ♜x a3#

or

1 ♖d1 ♔c6
 2 ♜c8+ ♙b7
 3 ♚h7+ ♜e7
 4 ♚h1+ ♜e4
 5 ♙b6 axb6#

Source: František Richter, Národní Osvození, 1935 (YACPDB: 261404)

Q6. Selfmate in 10. White to play and force Black to checkmate White in 10 moves. (6 marks)

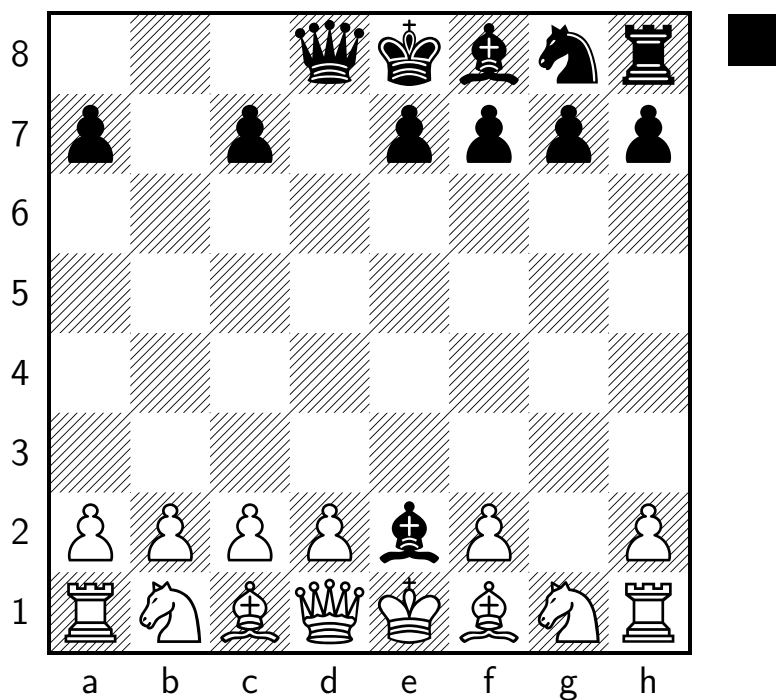


Answer:

- 1 ♖a7 ♜f8
- 2 ♜g8 ♜e8
- 3 ♜f8 ♜d8
- 4 ♜e8 ♜c8
- 5 ♜d8 ♜b8
- 6 ♜c8 ♜xc8
- 7 ♚b8+ ♜xb8
- 8 ♙b7+ ♜xb7
- 9 ♖b5+ ♜a7
- 5 ♜a6 ♜xa6#

Source: Edgar Dinwiddie Holladay, British Chess Magazine, 1965 (YACPDB: 303450)

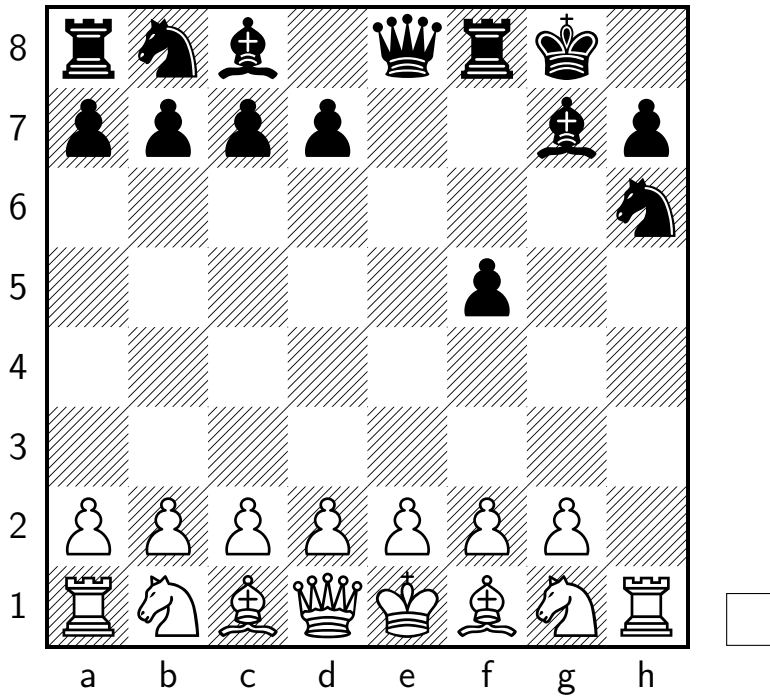
Q7. The position below occurred after the White's 7th move. List the moves played to reach this position. (6 marks)



Answer:

- 1 e4 d5
- 2 exd5 ♘c6
- 3 dxc6 ♙h3
- 4 cxb7 ♙xg2
- 5 bxa8 ♙ ♙xf1
- 6 ♙g2 ♙e2
- 7 ♙f1

Q8. The position below occurred after the Black's 7th move. List the moves played to reach this position. (6 marks)

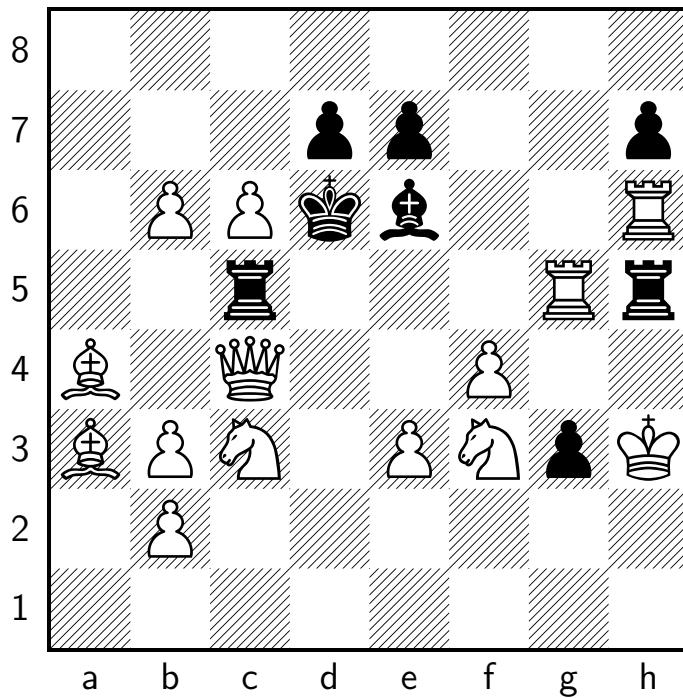


Answer:

- 1 h4 f5
- 2 h5 ♔f7
- 3 h6 ♚e8
- 4 h×g7 ♘h6
- 5 g8♘ ♙g7
- 6 ♘×e7 ♖f8
- 7 ♘g8 ♔×g8

Source: Joost de Heer, Messigny, 2005 (SchwalbeID: P1067879)

Q9. Answer the last 10 moves (5 moves each). (6 marks)



Answer:

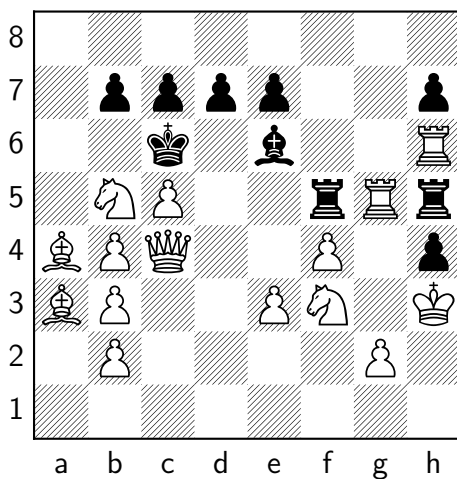
-1 h×g3+ g4 (Black - White)

-2 ♖c5+ b×c6+

-3 c5 b5+

-4 ♔d6 c×b6+

-5 b5 ♘c3+

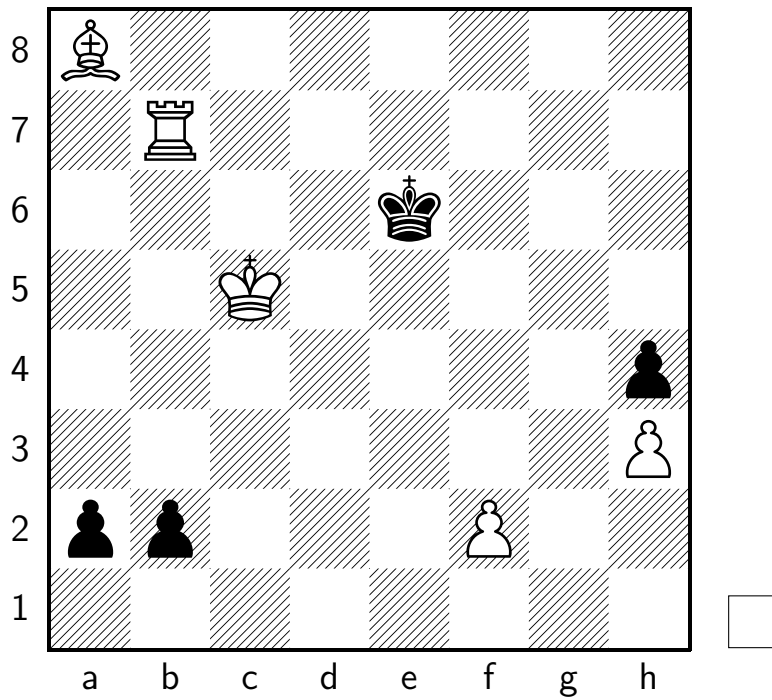


□ Followed by the moves below.

1 ♘c3+ b5 2 c×b6+ ♔d6 3 b5+ c5 4 b×c6+ ♖c5+ 5 g4 h×g3+

Source: H. Erikson, Stella Polaris, 1969

10. White play to win. (6 marks)



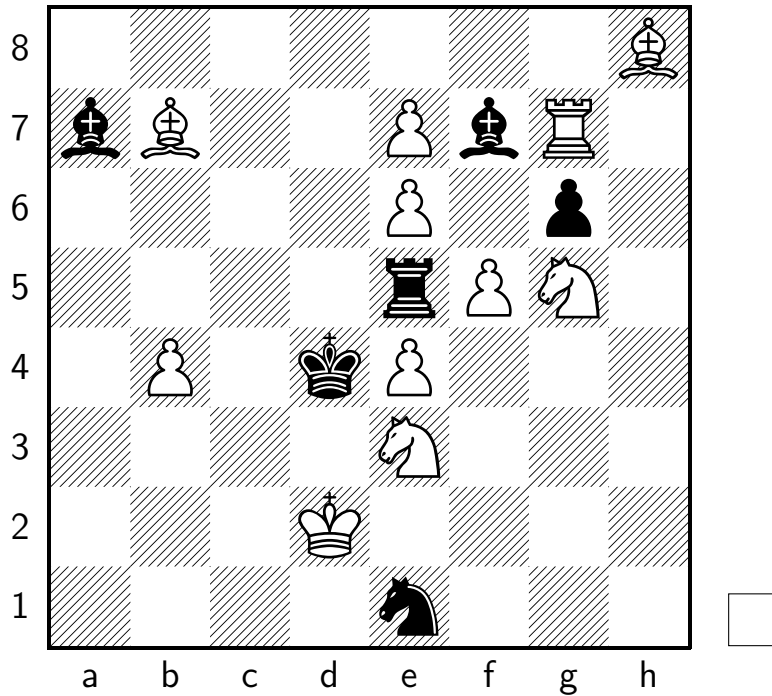
Answer:

1 ♖f7 ♔xf7
 2 ♘d5+ ♔f6
 3 ♘xa2 ♔e5
 4 ♘b1 ♔f4
 5 ♔d4

If 1... b1♚, 2 ♘d5+ ♔e5 3 f4#.

Source: Chessfever1

11. White play to win. (8 marks)



Answer:

1 ♖d5

Rook moves all met by discovered checks and then pin mates.

1... ♜xd5 2 ♜g8+ ♜e5 3 ♜d8#

1... ♜xe4 2 ♜h7+ ♜e5 3 ♜h4#

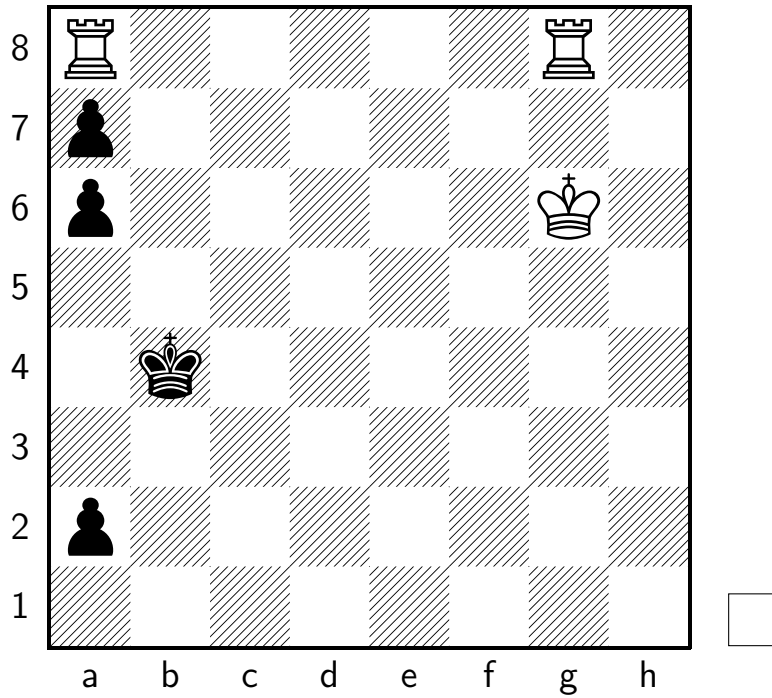
1... ♜xe6 2 ♜xf7+ ♜e5 3 ♘e6#

1... ♜xf5 2 ♜xg6+ ♜e5 3 ♘f5#

For other Black's replies, 2 ♘c2 ♘xc2 3 ♘f3#.

Source: Valentin Fedorovich Rudenko, Problemnoter, 1960, (YAPDB: 57240)

12. White play to win. (8 marks)

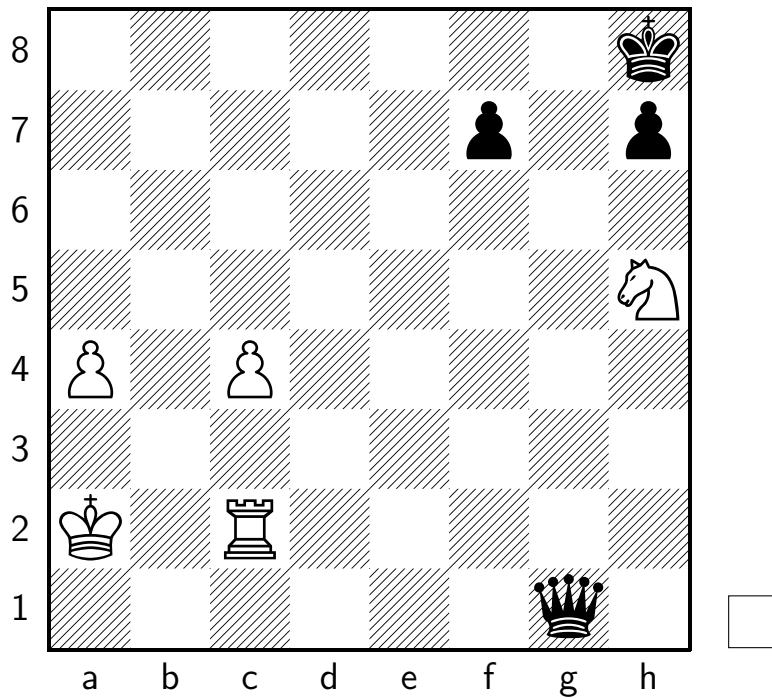


Answer:

1 ♖gb8+ ♔c3 2 ♜c8+ ♔d2 3 ♜d8+ ♔e2 4 ♜e8+ ♔f2
5 ♜e1! ♔xe1 6 ♜h8 ♔d1 7 ♜h2 a1♚ 8 ♜h1+

Source: Yehuda Hoch, L'Italia Scacchistica, 1978 (YACDB: 286661)

Q13. White play to win. (8 marks)



Answer:

1 ♖e2 ♔g8

2 ♘g7! ♔xg7

3 ♖e8+ ♔g8

4 ♖xg8+ ♔xg8+

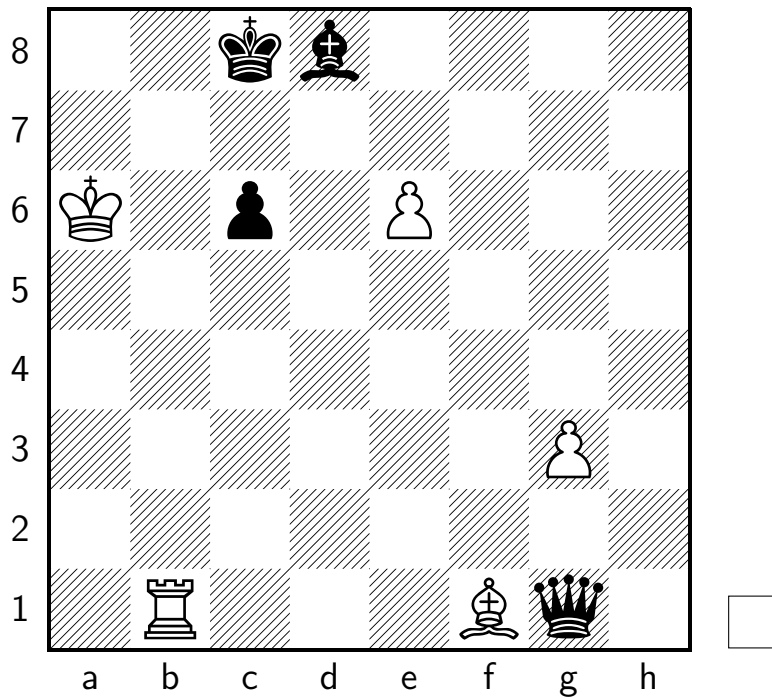
5 a5

2... ♔xg7 3 ♖g2+ ♔f8 4 ♖xg8+ ♔xg8+ 5 a5

1... h6 2 ♖e8+ ♔h7 3 ♘f6+ ♔g7 4 ♖g8+

Source: Dawid Przepiórka, Szachista Polski, 1920 (YACPDB: 288576)

14. White play to win. (8 marks)



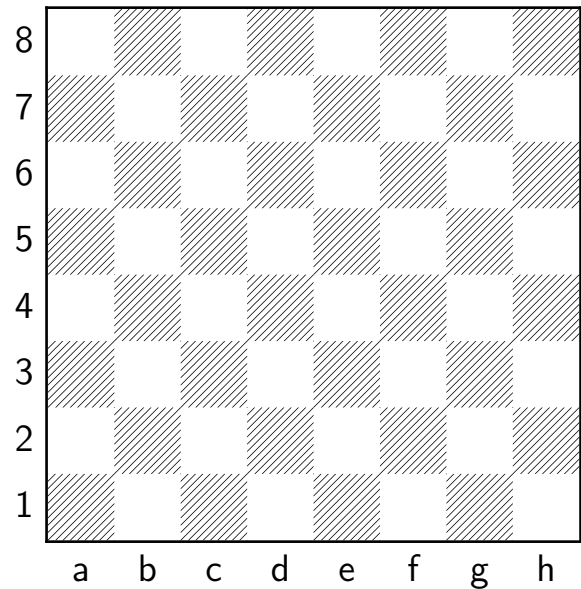
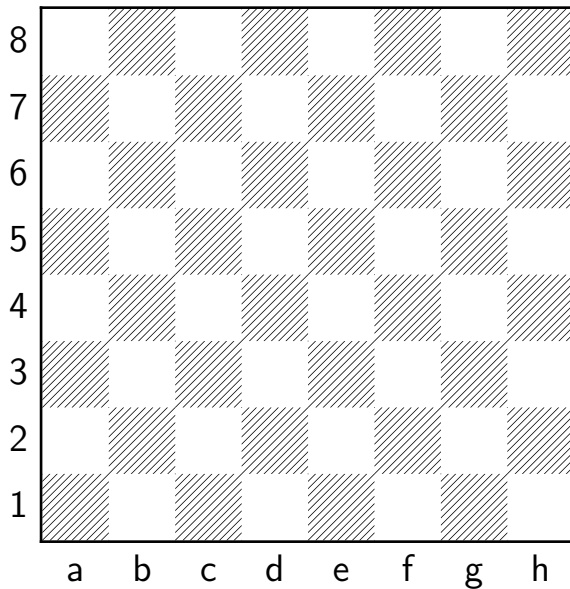
Answer:

1 e7 ♔xg3
2 ♖b8+ ♕xb8+
3 ♘h3+ ♔c7
4 e8 ♘#

Source: Slepian, Achalgazrda komunisti, 1983 (Modified) (YACPDB: 275122)

Q15. 8 Queens Independent puzzle. Place 8 queens on the board so that all 8 Queens don't attack each other. (6 marks)

There are 4,426,165,368 (${}_{64}C_8$) possible ways to place 8 queens on the board. Among those pattern, only 92 patterns are valid solutions. In one episode of the "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took 8 minutes 20 seconds to complete this task. Can you beat him?

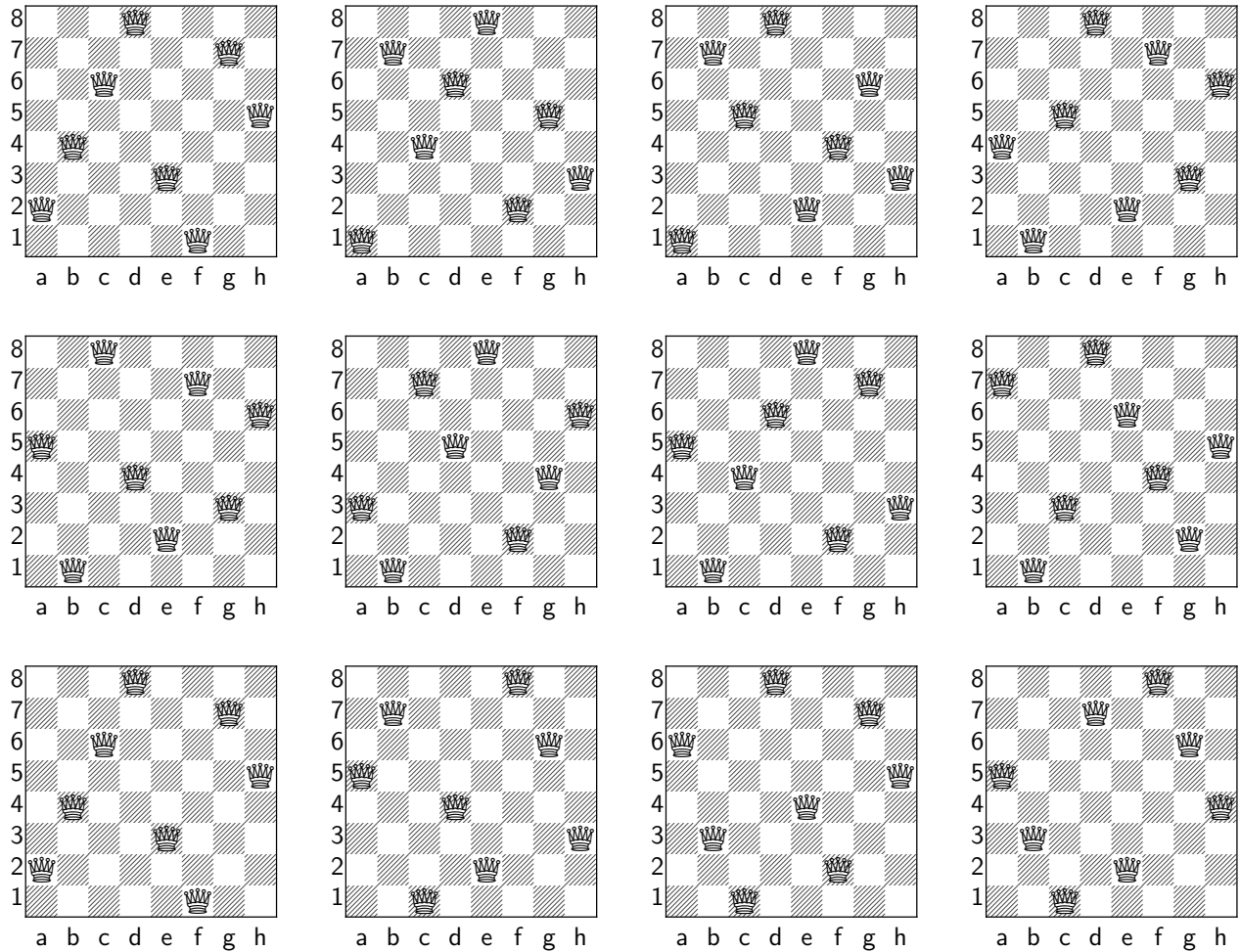


Instruction:

Use your 8 pawns instead of 8 queens. Fill 8 squares on the left board with the letter "Q". If you make a mistake on the left board, write a large cross over the left board and use the right board.

Answer:

The 12 fundamental solutions are shown below.



Each fundamental solution (except the right bottom solution) has 8 variants (its original form and the forms rotated 90° , 180° , or 270° , and their mirror images). The right bottom solution has only 4 variations as its 180° rotation is identical to the original solution. Therefore, the total number of the distinct solutions is 92 ($8 \times 11 + 4 \times 1$).

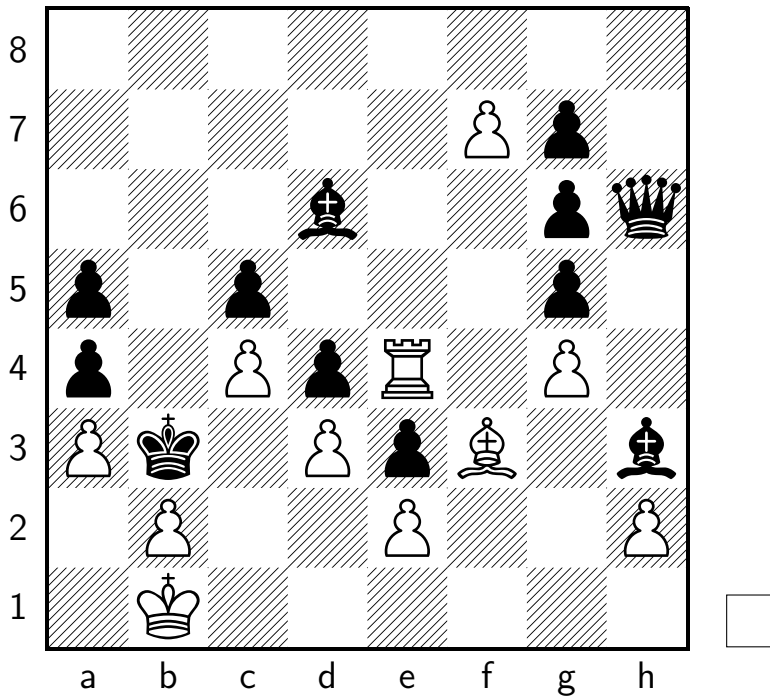
References:

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Eight_queens_puzzle

<https://www.brainbashers.com/queens.asp>

Q16. Mate in 6. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master, and is a famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

- 1 ♖e7! ♗xe7
- 2 f8♔ ♗xf8
- 3 ♗c6 ♔h4
- 4 ♗xa4+ ♕xa4
- 5 ♕a2 ♔e1
- 6 b3#

Source: "Grandmaster Solves Grandmaster-Level Puzzles" from Daniel Naroditsky's YouTube channel. The puzzle itself is puzzle ID925 of Chess.com (rating 3020 at the time).